Q+A

Age No Bar

Keep Moving, **Milind Soman's** latest book, co-written with his wife and mother, shows that you can be fit at any age



ALAMY

Q. *Keep Moving: Lessons on Staying Young in Mind and Body from India's Fittest Family* reads more like a memoir than a dry fitness manual. How did the book come about?

The original idea of three people of the same family who are at different age points [Milind, his mother Usha Soman and wife Ankita Konwar] talking about health and fitness came from the publisher Juggernaut. We decided that it might be more helpful for people to understand how we arrived at our individual lifestyle choices, rather than telling people what to do.

Q. What is the essential message of the book? Is age truly no bar when it comes to fitness?

Life is to be enjoyed, mentally, physically, emotionally and spiritually. All limits to enjoyment of the beauty of life are placed by us and, if we desire, we can change those limits to a certain extent with effort. At any age.

Q. Did you convert Ankita and your mother to the fit lifestyle, or were they already driven to be fit and healthy?

During the time I grew up, there was no concept of doing something extra to be fit or healthy. It was simpler and more natural. My mother was a teacher who started trekking at age 60. I was a competitive national-level swimmer from the age of nine to 23. I started marathon running at 37 as an experiment. Ankita chose her journey into fitness after a lot of emotional ups and downs.

Q. What's your daily diet like and will following it turn us into fitness gods too?

I have no diet or dietitian. What I eat, what I minimise or what I avoid comes from my personal experience. If everyone could learn to derive positive lessons from their experience, they may achieve a glimpse of divinity.

–with Amit Dixit